

 MOVING TO NEW ZEALAND

New Zealand

Aotearoa

The national relocation guide for healthcare professionals: the system, the money, the paperwork and the thirteen places you could call home.

Everything you need to know about moving to New Zealand.

New Zealand runs one health system, one tax system, one set of tenancy rules and one school framework from Kaitaia to Bluff. This is the layer underneath the thirteen destination guides: the systems, the money, the paperwork and the rhythm of the year, written for healthcare professionals and their families.

2nd

most peaceful country in the world

1st

for life-work balance, three years running

~5.3m

people, in a country the size of the UK

128km

the furthest you're ever from the sea

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Guides describe places, not employers. Hospitals are described rather than named, and salaries, visas and registration rules change, so we confirm the detail with you directly.

Where could you see yourself?

Every guide covers the same ground for one place: the work, the suburbs, the weather, the month's money and the weekends. Start with the one that caught your eye.



NORTH ISLAND

Auckland

Tāmaki Makaurau

New Zealand's biggest job market, two harbours, fifty islands and the widest choice of everything.



NORTH ISLAND

Northland

Te Tai Tokerau

The winterless north: generalist practice, two coasts and the country's cheapest housing on national pay.



NORTH ISLAND

Waikato

Kirikiriroa (Hamilton)

Tertiary work and rural breadth, a young river city, and Auckland pay on housing that costs about half.



NORTH ISLAND

Bay of Plenty

Te Moana-a-Toi

One of New Zealand's sunniest coasts and fastest-growing cities — beach life with a career to match.



NORTH ISLAND

Gisborne

Tairāwhiti

First light, uncrowded surf and rural practice with real autonomy, in a warm, close-knit community.



NORTH ISLAND

Hawke's Bay

Te Matau-a-Māui

Two sunny cities, a proper base hospital and the best food and wine in New Zealand — for less.

NORTH ISLAND



Palmerston North Te Papaioea

A flat, green university city with a base hospital, a cancer centre and the North Island's best housing value.

NORTH ISLAND



Wellington Te Whanganui-a-Tara

The compact, walkable capital: tertiary work for a big region and a fifteen-minute commute.

SOUTH ISLAND



Nelson Tasman Whakatū

The sunniest corner of New Zealand: a base hospital, three national parks and golden beaches on the doorstep.

SOUTH ISLAND



Christchurch Ōtautahi

A tertiary caseload, the best-value big-city housing and the Alps ninety minutes away.

SOUTH ISLAND



Central Otago

Broad rural medicine among lakes, vineyards and four ski fields, with friendly inland towns to call home.

SOUTH ISLAND



Dunedin Ōtepoti

A teaching hospital, the best-value housing of any main centre, and albatross twenty minutes away.

SOUTH ISLAND



Southland Murihiku

Invercargill, the Catlins and Fiordland: a base hospital and New Zealand's most affordable city housing.

Why people move to New Zealand

People rarely move to New Zealand for the salary alone. A move this big is about the whole life, and the people who settle best are the ones who plan for that life as carefully as the job.

New Zealand is the second most peaceful country in the world on the Global Peace Index 2026, and the most peaceful in the Asia-Pacific. It has ranked first for life-work balance three years running on Remote's global index, measured across statutory leave, working hours, healthcare and safety.

If you have children, the schooling picture is reassuring: New Zealand's 15-year-olds perform above the OECD average in maths, reading and science. On happiness the country ranks 11th, ahead of Australia, the United States and the United Kingdom.

What clinicians tell us they value most once they arrive is less dramatic: time back for family, the outdoors as part of an ordinary week, and practice that feels less rushed and more human.



Not the holiday, the weekend. Beaches, bush and tracks are rarely more than a short drive away.

WHAT PEOPLE LOVE

Scope of practice

Often more autonomy and room to work at the top of your training.

A different pace

Smaller teams, shorter commutes in many regions, and a life outside work that is taken seriously.

A good place to raise a family

Safe communities, good state schools and a childhood spent largely outdoors.

WORTH KNOWING

Planning trips home

Flights back to the UK, South Africa or elsewhere are worth building into your budget from the start.

Everyday costs

Housing, groceries and everyday essentials can cost more than many people expect, so plan with real numbers.

Building your circle

Most people find their feet within a few months, and clubs, schools and colleagues make it easier than many expect.

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The role is why you come. The life is why you stay.



Abel Tasman National Park, at the top of the South Island.

Two long, thin islands in the South Pacific

New Zealand is about the land area of the United Kingdom with roughly a thirteenth of the population. That single ratio explains more about daily life here than any other fact.

Cities are compact, and traffic is rarely on the scale you are used to. The coast is close to nearly everywhere, and so is farmland. A country this size has fewer hospitals and subspecialty posts than many larger systems: for many clinicians that closeness is the appeal, and if you are highly subspecialised, it is worth checking where your work is done.

Most of the population and most of the big hospitals are in the North Island, along with the warmer weather and the subtropical north. The South Island holds the mountains, the fiords, the Great Walks and the smaller populations.

It is longer than you think. Auckland to Wellington is a full day's drive or an hour's flight, and domestic flying is the normal way to cross the islands. Roads wind and climb: a three-hundred-kilometre journey is four hours, not three.



North Island: the volcanic plateau at Tongariro.



South Island: farmland above the harbour on Banks Peninsula, near Christchurch.

2

main islands,
North and South

1,600km

end to end

~1 in 4

people born
overseas

closer to two in
five in Auckland

3

official languages

English, te reo
Māori, NZ Sign
Language

Summer

DEC – FEB

20–25°C average daytime. Christmas at the beach, and a country that genuinely stops in January.

Autumn

MAR – MAY

17–21°C. The best walking weather, and Central Otago turning gold.

Winter

JUN – AUG

12–16°C. Mild by northern standards; skiing in both islands, rugby and Matariki.

Spring

SEP – NOV

16–19°C. Changeable, and the whole country gets out into the garden.

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Four climates, one country

Subtropical in Northland and Auckland; temperate across most of the North Island; continental in Canterbury and Otago, with hot dry summers and frosty winters; alpine in the Southern Alps. Temperatures fall as you travel south. Winter is a housing question as much as a weather one: choose a well-insulated, well-heated home and the season is easy to enjoy.



Autumn colour in Central Otago, in the south of the South Island.



A fiord in Fiordland, in the far south-west.

How the health system works

The fundamentals will feel recognisable to anyone from a comparable system. The differences are in the details: a no-fault accident scheme, the way primary care works, and an explicit commitment to equity.

Public hospital care is delivered by Health New Zealand | Te Whatu Ora, a single national organisation covering every region. That has one large practical consequence: pathways, pay scales and employment terms are national, so comparing two posts means comparing the work and the place rather than the package.

Public hospitals do the acute work, the complex work and most of the training. Private hospitals are mostly elective and smaller in scale than in many systems. Community and iwi providers deliver a great deal of frontline care, particularly in Māori and Pacific communities.

THE PUBLIC SYSTEM

Health New Zealand | Te Whatu Ora

Hospitals, specialist and community care across the country, under one national body.

PRIMARY CARE

General practice

Largely privately owned and publicly subsidised. Adults pay a part-charge per visit; children's care is heavily subsidised and often free.

NO-FAULT ACCIDENT COVER

ACC

Treatment and rehabilitation for injuries from accidents, for everyone in the country, regardless of fault, including visitors.

FUNDED MEDICINES

Pharmac

Decides which medicines are publicly funded, keeping most prescriptions low-cost at the counter.

ALONGSIDE, NOT INSTEAD

The private sector

Private insurance buys faster elective care and choice of specialist. It sits on top of public cover rather than replacing it.



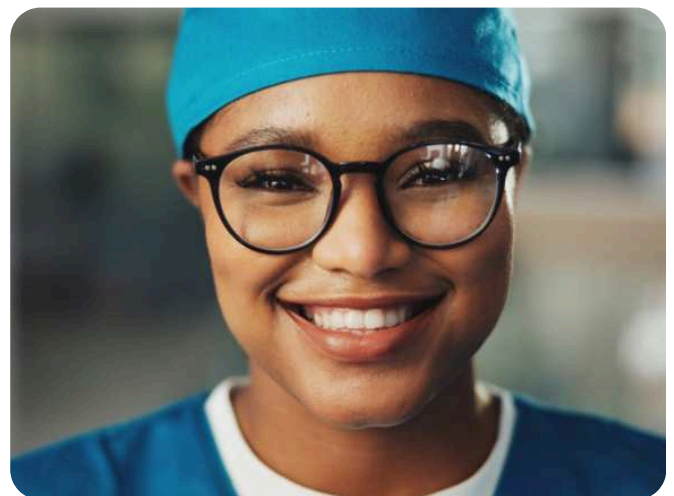
Flatter teams, first names, and leave you are expected to take.

What you'll notice in your first fortnight

- ✓ Fewer layers between you and a decision.
- ✓ Nurses with more autonomy than you may be used to.
- ✓ Pharmacists and allied health colleagues expected to challenge you, and thanked for it.
- ✓ Documentation systems that differ hospital by hospital, despite one national employer.
- ✓ A genuine expectation that you will ask when you don't know something.



On the ward: the work itself travels well.



Overseas-trained clinicians are part of every team.

Getting registered to practise

Every regulated health profession is overseen by its own board under the Health Practitioners Competence Assurance Act. Most internationally qualified clinicians who come to us are eligible; the work is in the paperwork and the timing.

The professions differ in detail, but every board is satisfying itself of the same three things: that you are properly trained, that you are safe and current, and that you can communicate clearly. Once you are registered and hold a current practising certificate, you can work.

Registration, a job offer and your visa usually progress alongside each other rather than in a strict queue. Some pathways begin with a period of supervised practice, which is a normal runway into the system, not a mark against you.

PROFESSION FAMILY	REGULATOR	THE SHAPE OF IT
Doctors, GPs, consultant radiologists	Medical Council of New Zealand	Pathways depend on training, specialty and where you qualified; often a period of supervised practice.
Radiographers, sonographers, radiation therapists, nuclear medicine, MRI	Medical Radiation Technologists Board	Registration by scope of practice, assessed against the modality you work in.
Physiotherapists	Physiotherapy Board of New Zealand	Some register directly; others complete a qualification and competence assessment first.
Occupational therapists	Occupational Therapy Board of New Zealand	International qualifications assessed against NZ standards, then an annual practising certificate.
Psychologists	New Zealand Psychologists Board	Several scopes; sometimes supervised practice on the way to full registration.
Anaesthetic technicians	Medical Sciences Council of New Zealand	Qualifications and experience assessed against the NZ scope and standards.



Check your eligibility

Qualifications, experience and country of training, looked at together.

○ Gather your documents

WEEKS

Transcripts, references and a certificate of good standing. The part most within your control.

○ English evidence, if required

IELTS (Academic) or OET. Many who trained and practised in English in a recognised country are exempt.

○ Board assessment

MONTHS

From a complete application to a decision. Varies by profession and pathway.

○ Registration & practising certificate

Renewed each year, with ongoing professional development.

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Check at the source

Boards set their own requirements, fees and timelines, and these change. Confirm the current detail with your regulator. Other regulated professions go straight to their own board. Ethicare are recruitment specialists, not a registration authority.



Te Anau, on the edge of Fiordland in Southland.

The visa usually follows the job

Almost every clinician arrives on an employer-sponsored work visa. You secure the role, your accredited employer supports the application, and the visa follows.

New Zealand has built faster routes for the skills it needs most, and healthcare is high on that list. The Green List sets out in-demand roles with streamlined pathways to residence, and many of the professions we place are on it.

It comes in two tiers. For the most in-demand roles, Straight to Residence lets you apply for residence directly with a qualifying job offer. For others, Work to Residence means working in the role for a qualifying period, then applying. Which tier applies is specific to the role and is reviewed periodically, so confirm your own occupation against the current list.

THE USUAL STARTING POINT

Accredited Employer Work Visa

Tied to a job offer from an accredited employer. For many, how they first arrive, with residence following on.

GREEN LIST · TIER 1

Straight to Residence

For eligible roles with a qualifying offer: residence from the outset, including your partner and dependent children.

GREEN LIST · TIER 2

Work to Residence

Work in a qualifying role for the required period, then apply for residence.

FOR YOUR FAMILY

Partner & dependent visas

Partners can often apply for a work visa and children for student visas, so the household moves together.

Ask the residence question in this form

- ☐ Which occupation will this role be sponsored under?
- ☐ Which list is it currently on, and which tier?
- ☐ What pay threshold is attached to it?
- ☐ What would my partner's work rights be on the resulting visa?

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A helpful note

We are recruiters, not licensed immigration advisers. Immigration New Zealand owns every rule here, including the Green List, pay thresholds and processing times, and settings change. Treat this as the shape of the thing and [immigration.govt.nz](https://www.immigration.govt.nz) as the fact. Start medicals and police certificates early; it is the simplest way to keep your start date on track.



Te Mata Peak, looking over the Heretaunga Plains in Hawke's Bay.



Wellington's cable car, five minutes from Lambton Quay to Kelburn.



New Regent Street in central Christchurch, on the heritage tram loop.

How pay works in public health

In the public health system, most roles are paid under national collective agreements. The scales are published, the same for everyone, and your step is the same in Invercargill as in Auckland.

Agreements are negotiated between Health New Zealand | Te Whatu Ora and the relevant union or professional body: the ASMS for senior medical staff, APEX for many allied health, scientific and medical-imaging roles, and the NZ Nurses Organisation for nursing. Each sets the pay scale, hours, leave and conditions for that profession.

Within each agreement is a series of steps. You are placed on one according to your experience and qualifications, and progress a step at a time with service. Agreements are renegotiated periodically, and increases apply across the board.

We deliberately don't publish salary figures. Rates change as agreements are renegotiated, and the right figure depends on your exact role, step and hours.



Not the salary: your step on the scale. How your overseas experience is credited is the single largest variable in what you are actually paid.



New Zealand dollars. Pay is set by collective agreements and scales, so the number is easy to check before you sign.

Beyond the base salary

- ✓ Penal and overtime rates for weekends, nights and public holidays.
- ✓ Allowances for on-call, recall, qualifications or responsibilities, defined in the agreement.
- ✓ KiwiSaver, with employer contributions, once you are eligible to join.
- ✓ Generous leave, including study leave and professional development funding in many agreements.
- ✓ Relocation support in some roles for international hires.

	NEW ZEALAND	AUSTRALIA	UNITED KINGDOM
How pay is set	National collective agreements; published steps	State/territory awards & enterprise agreements	National pay bands
Variation by location	Base is national; cost of living varies	Varies by state	Limited (London weighting)
Tax admin	Simple PAYE; no National Insurance; small ACC levy	PAYG; Medicare levy	PAYE plus National Insurance

What it costs to live here

Because base pay is national, the place you choose decides how far your salary goes. Housing in the bigger cities is the cost that surprises people most; in many regions it goes much further.

Auckland and Wellington are expensive to buy in and competitive to rent in; many regions are markedly cheaper. The same clinical salary stretches much further in a provincial city than in a main centre, which is why the cost chapter of each destination guide matters more than any national average.

Whether you are better off than at home is a household-by-household question. Plan around real, current numbers, and compare the place you are considering against the place you are leaving.

WHAT TO BUDGET FOR

Groceries

Particularly dairy, meat and anything imported. Fruit and vegetables are cheap in season and dear out of it.

Things that are shipped

Cars, electronics and clothing, because almost everything travels a long way.

Flights home

A real annual line for most families. Plan one trip every year or two, deliberately.

Eating out

Worth budgeting for, and tipping is not expected.

WHAT GOES FURTHER

Housing outside Auckland

Often by a wide margin, especially in the regions.

Time

Commutes are short in most places, and that time goes back into life.

Childcare for some ages

Funded early childhood hours make pre-school care more affordable than many expect.

Weekends

Beaches, tracks and parks, the things people actually do, are free.



Weatherboard and iron: the New Zealand street. Check insulation before you sign.



Vineyards in Hawke's Bay, where cellar doors are part of everyday life.



Weekend markets are where many households buy their fruit and vegetables.

BUDGET FOR YOUR FIRST WEEKS

- ✓ Bond and rent in advance, a car, appliances and school uniforms all land in the first weeks.
- ✓ Allow for the time between arriving and your first full pay.
- ✓ Planning for this early makes the first months far easier.



SOPHIE'S INSIGHTS

What I tell people about New Zealand

I moved to New Zealand in my twenties and stayed for years. What nobody told me is that the systems are the easy part. They are small, sensible and quick to learn.

The part that takes real effort is building a life a long way from the one you had. Give that the same planning you would give the paperwork, and picture the ordinary days, not just the highlights: the school run, the weekend, the quiet Tuesday.

Sophie Careem

Founder & Director, Ethicare Resourcing



A day trip with friends to Tongaporutu, on the Taranaki coast.



Christmas with the community: the people you meet here become family.

Te ao Māori in everyday practice

Te reo Māori is woven through everyday life, and in healthcare it arrives with a Treaty relationship that shapes how care is designed, measured and delivered. Effort is what people notice and appreciate; expertise grows with time.

Te Tiriti o Waitangi, signed in 1840 between Māori and the Crown, is the country's founding agreement. Its obligations run through public healthcare rather than sitting beside it, and your professional body will assess you against them. The clinicians who thrive treat it as part of good practice rather than paperwork.

Māori health outcomes lag behind across most measures. That is understood as a system issue, not a patient one, and closing the gap is an explicit objective of the service you are joining: meaningful work to be part of.

TE TIRITI IN PRACTICE

Partnership

Working with Māori patients, whānau and communities rather than delivering to them. Ask who should be part of the conversation before the plan is written.

TE TIRITI IN PRACTICE

Participation

Māori involvement in their own care and in how services are run. Kaupapa Māori providers deliver care by Māori, for Māori, and you will work alongside them.

TE TIRITI IN PRACTICE

Protection

Actively closing long-standing outcome gaps. Equity is not equality: giving some people more of your time is the standard, not favouritism.



A wharenui. You may be welcomed onto a marae for a pōwhiri or a team day; follow your host's lead.

TE WHARE TAPA WHĀ	WHAT IT COVERS
Taha tinana	The body: pain, function, mobility, strength
Taha hinengaro	Mind and emotions
Taha whānau	Family and belonging; who someone cares for, and who cares for them
Taha wairua	Spirit, purpose and identity
Whenua	Land and roots: the ground the four walls stand on



Taranaki Maunga: to many iwi, an ancestor as well as a mountain.

What cultural safety means

- ☐ Learn to pronounce names, place names and the local iwi correctly, and ask if unsure.
- ☐ Offer whānau a seat, and assume they are staying unless told otherwise.
- ☐ Don't assume the patient is the decision-maker, or that they are not.
- ☐ Notice when someone has gone quiet; silence is not agreement.
- ☐ Record goals in the person's own words.
- ☐ Welcome correction; it is offered as help.

You will not have to leave who you are behind

New Zealand is a genuinely multicultural country, and a quietly secular one. Whatever your faith, food or festivals, a community has very likely got there before you.

More than one in four people living here were born overseas. After European and Māori New Zealanders, the largest groups are Indian, Chinese and Samoan, with big, settled Filipino, South African and British communities and Pacific families from Tonga, the Cook Islands and Fiji.

Auckland is the centre of gravity: roughly a third of Aucklanders identify as Asian and around one in six as Pacific. Hamilton, Wellington and Christchurch each have large, established migrant communities, and the regional cities have more than newcomers expect, often built around the very hospitals and aged-care homes where you may work.

28.8%

of people born
overseas

2023 Census

51.6%

report no religion

2023 Census

32.3%

identify as
Christian

2023 Census

2.9%

identify as Hindu

2023 Census;
Islam is 1.5%

Religion here is mostly a private matter. Just over half the country ticked “no religion” at the last Census, but freedom of religion is protected in law, and so is freedom from discrimination because of your beliefs. Nobody will ask about your faith at work, and nobody will mind if you mention it.

That quiet tolerance cuts both ways. You will rarely see public displays of religion, yet temples, mosques, gurdwaras and churches of every tradition sit comfortably in ordinary suburbs, and their festivals spill happily into city parks.



A small stone church in the Mackenzie Basin, South Island. Faith here tends to be quiet, local and welcoming.

Christian churches are in every city and most towns, from Catholic, Anglican and Presbyterian parishes to lively Pentecostal congregations. Many hold services in other languages, and Syro-Malabar and Malayalam-speaking Catholic communities meet regularly in the main centres. Orthodox parishes, Greek, Russian, Serbian, Coptic and others, are found mainly in the larger cities.

Mosques and Islamic centres serve every main centre, with smaller cities often running a prayer space. Hindu temples are well established, especially in Auckland, Wellington and Hamilton, and gurdwaras offer worship and langar in most large cities. Buddhist temples and meditation centres are widespread. Jewish congregations are small and long-settled, mainly in Auckland and Wellington.

[CATHOLIC.ORG.NZ](https://www.catholic.org.nz) · [ANGLICAN.ORG.NZ](https://www.anglican.org.nz) ·
[PRESBYTERIAN.ORG.NZ](https://www.presbyterian.org.nz)

Christian

National churches with parishes nationwide. Ask the Catholic diocese where you are moving about Syro-Malabar and language Masses.

[FEDERATION OF ISLAMIC ASSOCIATIONS OF
NZ](https://www.federationofislamicassociations.org.nz) · [FIANZ.COM](https://www.fianz.com)

Muslim

The national body for regional Muslim associations, and the country's main halal certifier.

[HINDU COUNCIL OF NEW ZEALAND ·
HCNZ.ORG](https://www.hcncz.org)

Hindu

Peak body linking temples and cultural associations, with centres in each main city.

[SUPREME SIKH SOCIETY OF NZ ·
SUPREMESIKHSOCIETY.CO.NZ](https://www.supremesikhsofnewzealand.org.nz)

Sikh

Runs the country's largest gurdwara in south Auckland; local gurdwara committees serve the other main centres.

NZ BUDDHIST COUNCIL ·
BUDDHISTCOUNCIL.ORG.NZ

Buddhist

An umbrella for Buddhist organisations across traditions, from heritage temples to meditation groups.

NEW ZEALAND JEWISH COUNCIL ·
NZJC.ORG.NZ

Jewish

The national voice for Jewish communities, and the best route to local congregations and kosher suppliers.

Halal food is easy. Much of New Zealand's meat is halal-slaughtered for export, mainstream supermarkets and butchers stock certified halal meat, and the cities have dedicated halal butchers and restaurants. Kosher is harder: Auckland has the widest range, Wellington some, and elsewhere it is mostly ordering online or through the local Jewish community.

The calendar is generous. Diwali, Eid and Lunar New Year are celebrated publicly, often as city-wide events. Matariki, the Māori New Year in midwinter, became a public holiday in 2022. And Christmas falls in summer, so expect a barbecue, the beach and the long holiday break rather than snow.



Keep hold of your own culture and let New Zealand welcome you at the same time. You don't have to choose.

Etiquette at work

- ✓ First names are normal, for consultants and managers too. The tone is informal, but punctuality and doing what you said you would are taken seriously.
- ✓ Meetings and hospital events may open with a karakia (a short Māori blessing or reflection). Simply stand quietly; nobody expects you to join in at first.
- ✓ A simple "kia ora" works as hello, thank you and good luck, and colleagues notice when you use it.
- ✓ Directness is softened. Feedback often comes as a suggestion, and modesty is valued over self-promotion.
- ✓ It is reasonable to ask about prayer times, dress or dietary needs. Most employers will try to accommodate them, and many hospitals have a multi-faith room.

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Finding your community

Each destination guide includes a local directory of places of worship, cultural associations and specialist grocers for that region. Start there once you know where you are heading, and tell us about your faith and family: we are always glad to make an introduction before you land.



An Onam sadya with the Malayali community in Palmerston North.



Families from India celebrating with their parish in Palmerston North.

Moving as a family

For the healthcare professionals we work with, partners are usually eligible to work, children can generally come with you, and many roles offer a pathway to residence.

Children of many work-visa holders are treated as domestic students at state schools, which means free state schooling. Eligibility hinges on your specific visa, so confirm it before you plan a household budget. State schools may ask for a voluntary donation, so budget too for uniforms, devices and trips.

Popular schools operate enrolment zones, and living inside the zone secures a place. The school decision and the housing decision are the same decision, made in that order: schools first, then houses.

The school year runs from late January to mid-December in four terms. Government funding covers up to 20 hours a week of early childhood education for eligible three- to five-year-olds, and popular centres have waiting lists, so enquire before you arrive.



An ordinary afternoon, not a holiday.



Childhood here involves a lot of being outside.



Most of what people gain is the ordinary evening, outside, together.

○ The honeymoon

FIRST WEEKS

Everything is new and a little thrilling. The adrenaline carries you.

○ The dip

FIRST MONTHS

The novelty fades before belonging arrives. It is completely normal, and knowing it is coming makes it much easier.

○ Finding your feet

AROUND SIX MONTHS

A GP, a favourite beach, people you would call on a bad day.

○ Home

THE FIRST YEAR

You stop converting prices, and you are the one welcoming the next arrival.

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The partner question

In a smaller city clinical jobs may be plentiful while your partner's field is more specialised. Research their market as seriously as your own, before the shortlist rather than after the offer, so the move works for the whole household, teenagers included.



The ordinary weekend: a kayak, a quiet bay and nowhere to be.



Bush walks start young here.

Choosing where in New Zealand to live

Most people choose a job and inherit a city. It is worth doing it the other way round at least once, because the place is what you live in every day.

There are four main centres, Auckland, Wellington, Christchurch and Hamilton, and then a long list of provincial cities and regional centres that are often the more interesting proposition for a clinician. Beyond the main centres the pattern is consistent: better-value housing, shorter commutes, broader scope and close-knit teams.

Registration is national and the health service is one employer across the country, so moving region after two years is ordinary. Your first move need not be your last.

THE NORTH ISLAND

Most of the people and hospitals

Auckland's deep subspecialty market, the capital, and tertiary centres in Hamilton and Wellington.

Warmer, and subtropical at the top

From Northland's mild winters to the sunshine of Hawke's Bay and the Bay of Plenty.

Regional breadth

Gisborne, Palmerston North and Whangārei: wide scope and housing that goes further.

THE SOUTH ISLAND

Mountains, fiords and Great Walks

The Southern Alps, Fiordland and three national parks around Nelson.

Close-knit communities

Christchurch and Dunedin as tertiary centres, and rural posts with real independence and wide-open space.

A wide cost range

From Southland's great-value city housing to Central Otago's sought-after resort towns.



North: Auckland's wild west coast at Piha.



South: the Catlins coast, near the bottom of the country.

Four questions to build a shortlist

- ☐ What size of department do you actually want to work in?
- ☐ How far from a tertiary centre are you comfortable being?
- ☐ What do you want to be able to do on a Saturday without planning it?
- ☐ What does your partner need from the place?

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Shortlist three places

Then read the destination guide for each. That is where the suburbs, the departments, the commutes, the schools and the weekends live. And weigh more than housing cost: work for a partner and how easily you can fly home matter just as much.



Wellington's eastern suburbs, with the airport and Cook Strait beyond.

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**The question isn't whether New Zealand is beautiful.
It's whether an ordinary Tuesday here feels like yours.**

Numbers and websites to keep handy

The official sources worth bookmarking before you go: health, schools, visas, tax, renting and settling in.

EMERGENCIES & HEALTH ADVICE

Emergency services

Police, fire and ambulance, any time
111

Healthline

Free 24/7 health advice from a nurse, in any language
0800 611 116

Need to talk?

Free call or text a trained counsellor, 24/7
1737

National Poisons Centre

24/7 advice if someone may have been poisoned
0800 764 766

PlunketLine

Free 24/7 support for parents of under-fives
0800 933 922

HEALTHCARE FOR YOUR FAMILY

Health New Zealand | Te Whatu Ora

How public healthcare works and who is eligible
tewhatauora.govt.nz

Healthpoint

Find a GP, pharmacy, dentist or urgent care near you
healthpoint.co.nz

ACC

Accident cover for everyone in New Zealand, including visitors
acc.co.nz

VISAS, REGISTRATION & WORK

Immigration New Zealand

Visas, the Green List and residence pathways
immigration.govt.nz

Immigration Advisers Authority

Check an adviser is licensed before you pay
iaa.govt.nz

Responsible authorities

The registration board for every regulated health profession
health.govt.nz/regulated-health-professions

Nursing Council of New Zealand

Registration for nurses
nursingcouncil.org.nz

Medical Council of New Zealand

Registration for doctors
mcnz.org.nz

SCHOOLS & CHILDCARE

Find a school

Every school, with its enrolment zone
educationcounts.govt.nz/find-school

Education Review Office

Independent reports on schools and early learning
ero.govt.nz

Parents and whānau

How schooling, early childhood education and fees work
parents.education.govt.nz

MONEY, HOME & GETTING AROUND

Inland Revenue (IRD)

Your IRD number, tax and KiwiSaver
ird.govt.nz

Tenancy Services

Renting rules, bonds and market rents by area
tenancy.govt.nz

NZ Transport Agency

Converting your overseas driver licence
nzta.govt.nz/driver-licences

Powerswitch

Compare power companies in your area
powerswitch.org.nz

Sorted

Free, independent budgeting tools
sorted.org.nz

MPI · pets

Bringing cats and dogs into New Zealand
mpi.govt.nz/bring-send-to-nz/pets-travelling-to-nz

SETTLING IN

Citizens Advice Bureau

Free, confidential help with almost any question
0800 367 222 cab.org.nz

Ministry for Ethnic Communities

Support and connections for new migrant communities
ethniccommunities.govt.nz

Department of Conservation

Huts, tracks, campsites and Great Walks bookings
doc.govt.nz



Always check the source

Rules, fees and services change. Treat these as starting points and confirm details with the organisation. Ethicare are recruitment specialists, not licensed immigration advisers.

Six steps, and someone beside you for each one

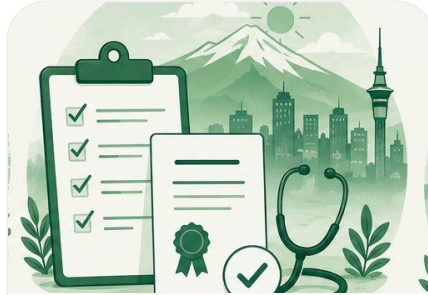
Moving country is a sequence of decisions. We take them with you in order, so you are never solving step five before step two is done.



STEP 1

Discovery call

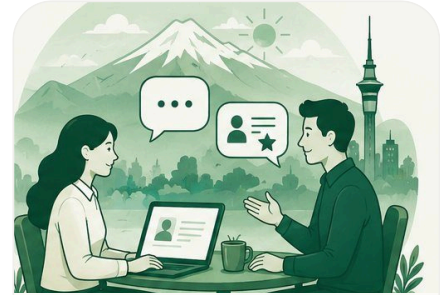
A relaxed conversation about your profession, your family and what you want from a move. No forms, no pressure.



STEP 2

Eligibility & registration

We map your route to New Zealand registration and help you gather the evidence the regulator will ask for.



STEP 3

Opportunities & interviews

Roles matched to where you want to live and how you like to work, with honest briefings before every interview.



STEP 4

Offer & decision support

We help you read the offer properly: pay step, relocation support, roster and what the team is really like.



STEP 5

Visa & relocation guidance

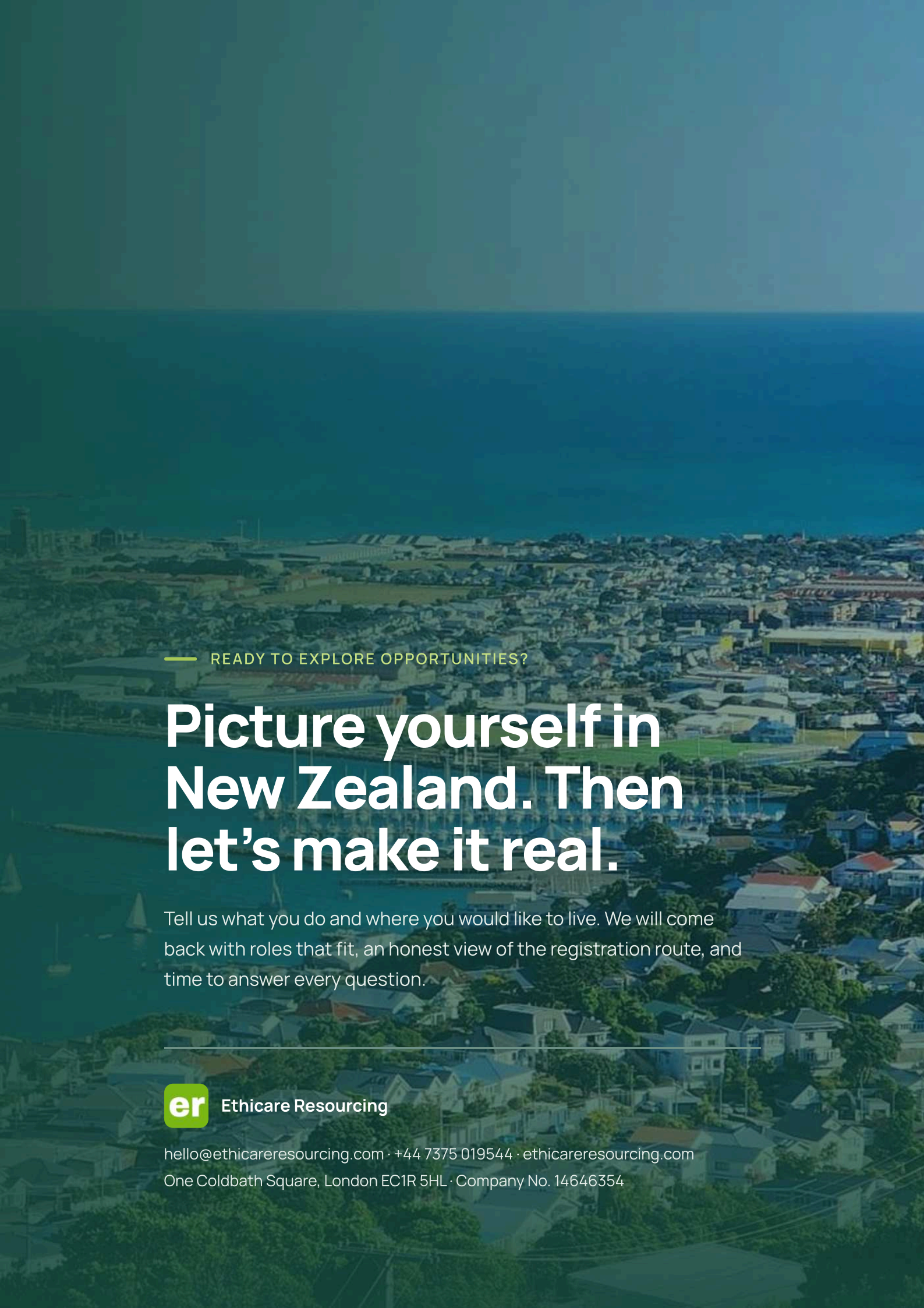
Practical guidance on visas, shipping, pets, schools and the first weeks, so nothing arrives as a surprise.



STEP 6

Settling in

We stay in touch after you land, from your first week on the ward to your first winter.



— READY TO EXPLORE OPPORTUNITIES?

Picture yourself in New Zealand. Then let's make it real.

Tell us what you do and where you would like to live. We will come back with roles that fit, an honest view of the registration route, and time to answer every question.



Ethicare Resourcing

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